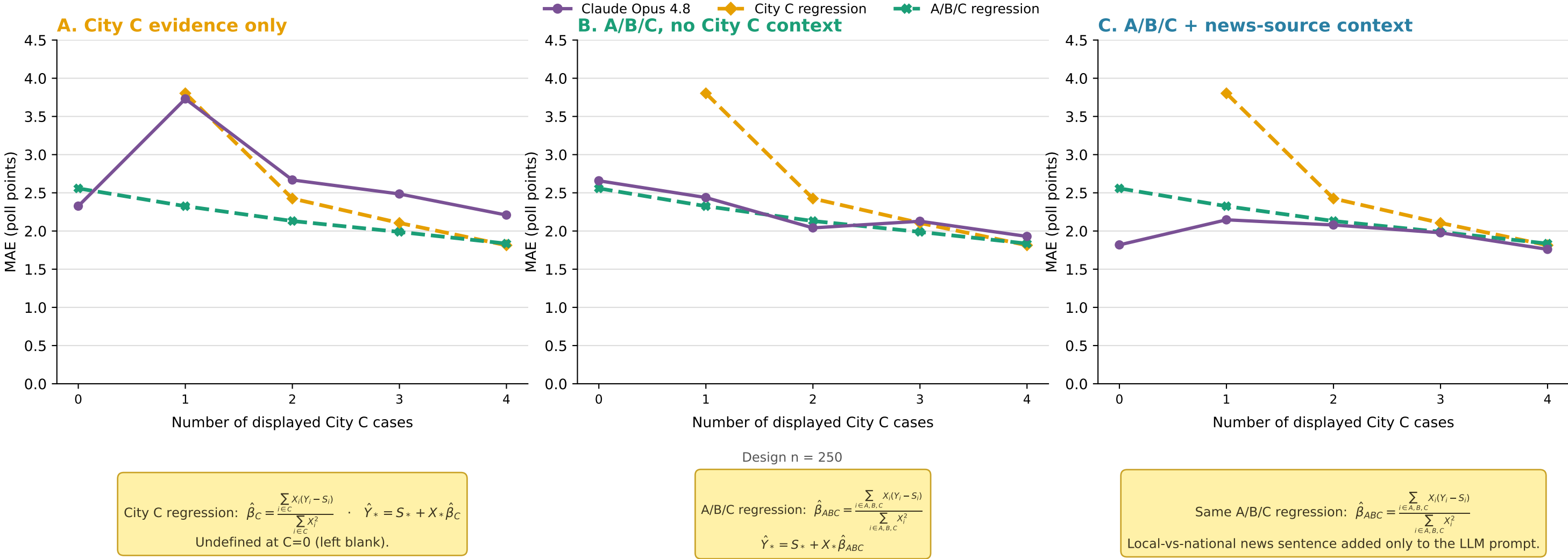


Claude Opus 4.8 · fair n=250 stable-response design

3,749/3,750 parsed responses · common matched subsets · data noise $\epsilon \sim N(0, 5.0^2)$ (DGP only) · fixed 4 A cases + 4 B cases · City C cases 0–4

You are forecasting a post-news local-election poll. Each table row is a separate polling case, not a time series. Positive net news favors the candidate and negative net news harms the candidate. Poll change is the poll at the end of the case minus the starting poll. Within a city, its typical responsiveness to net news is stable across cases, although individual end polls remain noisy. When two displayed rows share a Pair label, they are matched: they begin at the same poll and receive equal-sized net-news scores in opposite directions.



What the LLM sees — frozen episode 0 with 4 City C cases

A. City C evidence only

CITY C						
No additional background information is available.						
Case	Pair	Start	News	Change	End	
1	1	57.8	+8	+9.4	67.2	
2	1	57.8	-8	-1.8	56.0	
3	2	47.4	+10	+8.1	55.5	
4	2	47.4	-10	-10.6	36.8	

B. A/B/C, no City C context

CITY A						
Background: Residents generally encounter campaign developments through national news coverage, where campaign stories receive sustained attention and tend to produce larger immediate poll movements.						
Case	Pair	Start	News	Change	End	
1	1	45.4	-8	-6.5	38.9	
2	1	45.4	+8	+12.2	57.6	
3	2	55.1	-6	+0.9	56.0	
4	2	55.1	+6	+11.4	66.5	

CITY B						
Background: Residents generally encounter campaign developments through local news coverage, where campaign stories compete with local issues and tend to produce smaller immediate poll movements.						
Case	Pair	Start	News	Change	End	
1	1	35.0	-10	-5.6	29.4	
2	1	35.0	+10	+9.3	44.3	
3	2	51.8	-10	-5.5	46.3	
4	2	51.8	+10	+7.2	59.0	

CITY C						
No additional background information is available.						
Case	Pair	Start	News	Change	End	
1	1	57.8	+8	+9.4	67.2	
2	1	57.8	-8	-1.8	56.0	
3	2	47.4	+10	+8.1	55.5	
4	2	47.4	-10	-10.6	36.8	

C. A/B/C + news-source context

CITY A						
Background: Residents generally encounter campaign developments through national news coverage, where campaign stories receive sustained attention and tend to produce larger immediate poll movements.						
Case	Pair	Start	News	Change	End	
1	1	45.4	-8	-6.5	38.9	
2	1	45.4	+8	+12.2	57.6	
3	2	55.1	-6	+0.9	56.0	
4	2	55.1	+6	+11.4	66.5	

CITY B						
Background: Residents generally encounter campaign developments through local news coverage, where campaign stories compete with local issues and tend to produce smaller immediate poll movements.						
Case	Pair	Start	News	Change	End	
1	1	35.0	-10	-5.6	29.4	
2	1	35.0	+10	+9.3	44.3	
3	2	51.8	-10	-5.5	46.3	
4	2	51.8	+10	+7.2	59.0	

CITY C						
Background: City C residents generally encounter campaign developments through national news coverage.						
Case	Pair	Start	News	Change	End	
1	1	57.8	+8	+9.4	67.2	
2	1	57.8	-8	-1.8	56.0	
3	2	47.4	+10	+8.1	55.5	
4	2	47.4	-10	-10.6	36.8	

A new City C case begins with a poll of 53.9 and has net news +5. What poll do you predict at the end of this new case? Think carefully about the expected poll, but do not provide step-by-step working. Respond with one JSON object only: {"rationale": "one short sentence", "predicted_poll": <number from 0 to 100>}